

H/O – Vital Signs Normal Ranges Reference Card

Day 6 | GA Healthcare Training & Consulting | Nurse Aide Training Program

Name: _____ Date: _____

Vital Signs at a Glance

Vital Sign	Normal Adult Range	Report If...	Notes
Temperature (Oral)	97.6°F – 99.6°F (36.5°C – 37.6°C)	Above 100.4°F (fever) or below 96°F	Axillary is 1° lower; Rectal is 1° higher
Pulse Rate	60 – 100 bpm	Below 60 or above 100 bpm; irregular rhythm	Count for a full 60 seconds if irregular
Respirations	12 – 20 breaths/min	Below 12 or above 20/min; labored, noisy, or absent	Count without telling the resident
Blood Pressure	Less than 120/80 mmHg	Above 140/90 (HTN); Below 90/60 (hypotension)	Take in same arm each time; resident rested
Oxygen Saturation (SpO2)	95% – 100%	Below 92% — notify nurse immediately	Report any drop from resident's baseline
Weight	Varies by resident	Gain or loss of 2+ lbs in 24 hrs or 5+ lbs in 1 week	Same scale, same time, same clothing each time

Temperature Methods

Method	Site	Add/Subtract	Use When
Oral	Under tongue	Standard (baseline)	Cooperative adults; no oral issues
Axillary	Under armpit	Add 1°F to convert to oral equivalent	Children; when oral route is contraindicated
Rectal	Rectum	Subtract 1°F to convert to oral equivalent	Accurate but used less; requires caution
Tympanic	Ear canal	Consult thermometer instructions	Quick; avoid if ear infection present

Blood Pressure Classification (AHA)

Category	Systolic (mmHg)	Diastolic (mmHg)
Normal	Less than 120	Less than 80
Elevated	120 – 129	Less than 80
High (Stage 1)	130 – 139	80 – 89
High (Stage 2)	140 or higher	90 or higher
Hypertensive Crisis	Higher than 180	Higher than 120
Hypotension (Low)	Less than 90	Less than 60

Documentation Practice

Record the following vital signs using correct format:

Temp (°F)	Pulse (bpm)	Respirations (bpm)	BP (mmHg)	SpO2 (%)